

CONSEQUENCE

Integrity -1

A Frayed Thread

A small thing comes loose in the past — a letter delivered a day late, a face remembered that shouldn't be. Nothing the present notices yet. But the timeline notices.

Timeline Integrity -1.

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Double-Booked

For ninety seconds, two versions of the same street corner in 1908 exist at once. They resolve. Mostly.

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The Wrong Pocket

Something modern was left behind down there — a coin, a button, a fibre. Some future archaeologist is going to have a very confusing afternoon.

Timeline Integrity -1.

CONSEQUENCE

Integrity -2

Cascade

One change tugs another, which tugs three more. By the time anyone traces it back, the knot has pulled tight across two centuries.

Timeline Integrity -2.

CONSEQUENCE

Integrity -2

Paradox Feedback

The machine hums at a frequency you've never heard before and the lights in the lab — every lab, on the timeline — flicker in unison. That can't be good.

Timeline Integrity -2.

CONSEQUENCE

Cash -

Customs Trouble

Bringing back period currency seemed clever until you tried to spend it. The numismatist who 'authenticated' it took a generous cut and asked no questions.

Lose 2 Cash (down to a minimum of 0).

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Cash −

Grant Clawback

The funding committee has 'concerns about methodology.' They always do, right after a noisy jump.

Lose 3 Cash (down to a minimum of 0).

CONSEQUENCE

Cash −

Equipment Loss

Something didn't come back through the door in one piece. Replacing it is neither cheap nor covered by the warranty.

Lose 2 Cash (down to a minimum of 0).

CONSEQUENCE

Cash +

A Private Buyer

A discreet collector hears what you've been up to and makes an unsolicited offer for 'anything you don't strictly need.' You sell them a crate of off-cuts.

Gain 3 Cash.

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Patent Windfall

A material you glanced at in the field turns out to be trivially patentable in the present. The licence cheque clears before you've finished the paperwork.

Gain 3 Cash.

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Reputation −

Peer Review

A rival re-examines your last paper and finds a genuine error — the dating was off, the provenance shaky. They are not wrong. This is the system working as intended; it still stings.

Reputation −2 (an honest correction — NOT disrepute).

CONSEQUENCE

Reputation −

Retraction

One of your findings can't be reproduced, and you do the decent thing and withdraw it. Better caught now than built upon. The pile gets a little shorter.

Reputation −1 (an honest withdrawal — NOT disrepute).

CONSEQUENCE

Reputation +

Corroboration

A find someone else made in the present quietly confirms something you published months ago. Vindication is the slowest and sweetest currency in science.

Gain 1 Reputation.

CONSEQUENCE

Reputation +

An Invited Lecture

Word of your last expedition reaches the right ears, and the invitation is to the kind of hall that doesn't usually let your sort in. You give a good talk.

Gain 1 Reputation.

CONSEQUENCE

Module –

Module Strain

You pushed one system past where it wanted to go, and a level of it gives out — a coil, a lens, a seal. It can be rebuilt, but not tonight.

Lose one level from a machine module of your choice (minimum level 1; Stabiliser minimum 2). If nothing can drop, ignore.

CONSEQUENCE

Clean

A Quiet Return

You half-expect the lights to flicker or the phone to ring with bad news. Neither happens. The door closes behind you and the timeline holds. You exhale.

No effect. This one was clean.

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Near Miss

Something almost went wrong — you felt the machine catch, saw the needle twitch — and then it didn't. You'll tell this one at parties as if you were never worried.

No effect. Lucky.

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Lab Superstition

The team insists the jump was cursed and performs the usual rituals — the tea, the tapping, the one rude word said to the Capacitor. It works, in that nothing happens.

No effect.